

JPMS portal: hosting upgrade proposal

Prepared for the Managing Director | 4 September 2026 | Jewel Enterprises Ltd

Hosting cost today

£190

per month, about £2,300 a year

After the upgrade

£275

per month, about £3,300 a year

Projected increase

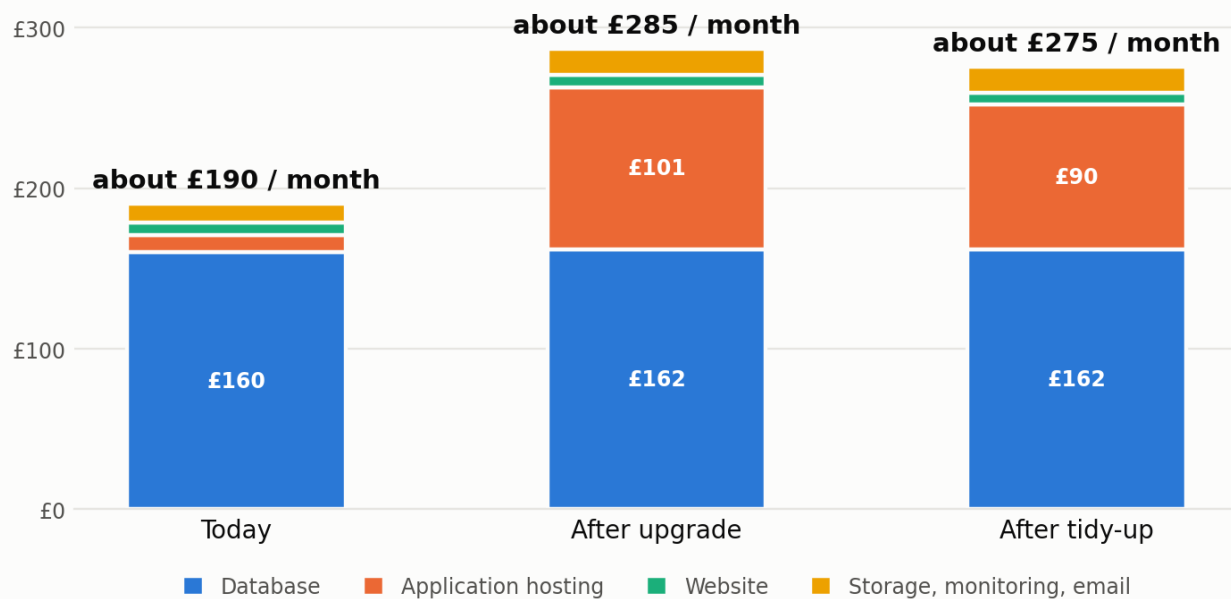
+£85

per month: about £1,020 a year,
roughly £7 per user per month

In one paragraph

The portal works, but people sometimes see it hang for around seven seconds before a page responds. That is not a fault in our software: it is how the cheapest tier of the hosting we currently use behaves. To save money, the provider switches our application's server off whenever nobody has used it for about twenty minutes, and switching it back on takes seven seconds. The first person to click after a quiet spell pays that wait, and so does everyone every time we release an update. The proposal is to move the application onto a server that stays on permanently, sitting in the same datacentre as our database, with the ability to release updates without any interruption. It costs about £85 a month more than we pay today, confirmed against Microsoft's published UK price for the new server (£90.30 a month).

Estimated monthly hosting cost by service



"After tidy-up" is the second step, where two smaller servers we run today are folded onto the new one. The new server is priced from Microsoft's published UK list price; the other lines are estimates at list price. All figures exclude VAT; the first month's invoice will confirm them.

What changes, service by service

Service	What it does	Today	After	Change
Database	Holds all portal data: projects, work orders, valuations, documents index. Already always-on with backups copied to a second region. No change to the service itself; backups kept for longer.	£160	£162	+£2
Application hosting	The server that runs the portal's logic. Today it is a pay-per-use tier that switches itself off when idle (the cause of the freezes). Replaced by a permanently-on server in the same datacentre as the database (£90.30 at Microsoft's published UK price). The £90 also absorbs the two smaller servers we run today.	£11	£90	+£79
Website	Serves the portal pages to browsers. No change.	£7.50	£7.50	-
Storage, monitoring, email	Drawing and document files, performance monitoring, and the emails the portal sends. Document storage gains a second copy in another region.	£12	£16	+£4
Total		£190	£275	+£85

What the business gets for the extra £85 a month

No more freezes. The seven-second hang disappears because the server is never switched off.

Updates without interruption. New releases go live on a standby copy and are swapped in; today every release restarts the portal for everyone using it.

Faster pages generally. The application and the database will sit in the same datacentre. Today they are in Amsterdam and Dublin respectively, and every question the application asks the database makes that round trip.

Better protection of the data. Point-in-time recovery of the database extended from 7 to 35 days, weekly backups kept for 12 weeks, and drawing and compliance documents copied to a second region.

Visibility. We can see how the application is performing and act before users notice, which the current tier does not allow.

Risk and reversibility

The change is made alongside the current setup, tested, and then switched over; there is no downtime for users and the switch can be reversed in minutes if anything is wrong. There are no one-off charges from Microsoft, and the new server is billed by the hour, so it can be cancelled at any time. The database, the system's most valuable component, is not touched other than lengthening its backup retention. The figures above are estimates at list price and will be confirmed against the first invoice after the change.